

" A LONG ^{WAY} ~~BACK~~ BACK. "

THE AMBULANCE WAS ROLLING CAUTIOUSLY ALONG THE ~~ROAD~~ ICEY ROAD, SLIPPING FROM SIDE TO SIDE. INSIDE, IN SPITE OF THE EXTREME COLD, IT WAS WARM AND COMFORTABLE. THE NOISE OF THE FAN IN THE ~~AMBULANCE~~ HEATER MADE A FAINT METALIC WHIR. ~~XXXXXX~~ THE ONLY LIGHT WAS A PALE GREENISH GLOW WHICH EMANATED FROM THE DASH PANEL, CASTING A QUEER COLOR ONTO THE FACES OF THE DRIVER AND HIS ASSISTANT.

ON THE LITTERS IN THE REAR, WERE MYSELF AND THREE OTHER MEN. WE ~~XX~~ LAY THERE SILENT, HALF ASLEEP FROM THE GREAT TIREDNESS THAT HAD POSSESSION OF US. ONE OF THE MEN MOANED A LITTLE, LIKE A MAN TALKING IN HIS SLEEP. HE HAD A HEAD WOUND ^(was) AND SEEMED TO BE IN PAIN.

THE ONLY CONVERSATION WAS THAT BETWEEN THE DRIVER AND HIS ASSISTANT, CURSING THE ROADS. AND WONDERING IF WE WOULD MAKE IT TO THE HOSPITAL TO WHICH WE WERE HEADED WITHOUT RUNNING INTO A FLOCK OF RUNSTEDT'S TANKS SOMEWHERE ALONG THE WAY.

OCCASIONALLY, ABOVE THE SOUND OF THE MOTOR, THE RUMBLE OF THE ARTILLERY COULD BE HEARD, AND WE ALL WONDERED TO OURSELVES IF IT WAS OURS OR THE GERMANS.

IT WAS SOME TIME ~~XXXXX~~ PAST MIDNIGHT WHEN WE REACHED THE BELGIAN TOWN OF VERVIERS WHERE THE HOSPITAL WAS LOCATED. THE AMBULANCE WAS STOPPED SEVERAL TIMES BY SENIRYS AND DIFFERENT ROAD BLOCKS WHICH HAD BEEN SET UP THROUGHOUT THE TOWN. ~~IT~~ ~~SEEMS THAT~~ GERMAN PARATROOPERS HAD BEEN DROPPED ON THE OUTSKIRTS OF TOWN JUST BEFORE DARK AND THERE WAS ~~AN~~ EXTRA ALERINESS. ~~IN THE TOWN.~~ ^{UP A LONG HILL}

WE WOUND THROUGH THE STREETS, ~~OF THE TOWN~~, AND FINALLY THE AMBULANCE CAME TO A STOP. THE REAR DOORS WERE OPENED AND EAGER HANDS BEGAN TO UNDO THE STRAPS THAT TIED THE LITTERS DOWN,

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AND PULLED US FROM THE VEHICLE.

~~XXXX~~ I WAS CARRIED INTO A LONG TENT WARD, ~~WHICH WAS XXXXXX~~ ^{AND} ~~WERE~~ ^{WERE} LINED NEATLY DOWN THE SIDES. IN THE AISLE IN THE MIDDLE WERE THREE GLOWING, RED SLOVES. ~~AND~~ OFF TO ONE SIDE, ALONG ABOUT THE MIDDLE OF THE TENT WAS A DESK, A MEDICINE LOCKER AND ~~LOTS OF~~ ^{SEVERAL} CABINETS AND CHESTS FULL OF ~~BANDAGES~~ ^{BANDAGES}, INSTRUMENTS AND OTHER PARAPHRANALIA. ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ TWO NURSES, DRESSED IN ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ AN ASSORTMENT OF BOTTLES AND JARS. NEAT & I FATIGUES, COMBAT BOOTS AND ^{WITH} THEIR HAIR TUCKED INTO WOOL-KNIT CAPS, WERE BUSTLING BUSILY ABOUT THE WARD, THEY BOTH WERE BEING VERY CHEERFUL AND TRYING TO SEEM NONCHALANT. BUT I NOTICED THAT EACH TIME THE BIG CORPS ARTILLERY HOWITZERS THAT WERE FIRING FROM OUTSIDE OF TOWN OPENED UP, THEY WOULD WINCE AND GET A ~~SCARY~~ ^{SCARY} FRIGHTENED LOOK ON THEIR FACES. THEY WERE BRAVE GIRLS THOUGH. A LOT OF WOMEN WOULD HAVE DROPPED WHATEVER THEY HAD IN THEIR HANDS AT THE TIME, AND RUN LIKE THE VERY DEVIL. BUT NOT THOSE TWO. THEY WERE GOING UP AND DOWN THE LINES OF COTS GIVING SHOTS AND HANDING OUT APC PILLS JUST AS IF THEY WERE IN SOME NICE QUIET HOSPITAL IN THE STATES, TAKING CARE OF A BUNCH OF ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ EXPECTANT MOTHERS.

I WAS CARRIED TO ONE OF THE COTS IN ABOUT THE MIDDLE OF THE WARD, ALMOST OPPOSITE THE DESK OF THE WARD ^{HEAD} NURSE. SHE WAS A BIG BLONDE ~~XXXXXX~~ SWEDISH-LOOKING WOMAN WITH A SMILE LIKE AN ANGEL. AT LEAST IT SEEMED THAT WAY TO ME. ~~IXXXXSXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ ^{I MUST HAVE BEEN A SIGHT OVER} ~~XXXXXX~~. I WAS A MESS. I HAD ~~XXXXXX~~ A WEEK'S GROWTH OF BEARD, AND I WAS CAKED WITH MUD; MY CLOTHING WAS ALSO COVERED WITH ^{MY FACE, EVERYTHING.} MY HANDS WERE ~~VERY~~ DIRTY. THEY ACTUALLY HURT, ^{BE} ~~BECAUSE~~ I MUST HAVE SMELLED LIKE SOMETHING OUT OF A CAVE. IT HAD BEEN ALMOST A MONTH SINCE I HAD BATHED. YET SHE GAVE ME A BIG SMILE LIKE I WAS ROBERT TAYLOR, OR SOMEBODY.

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AS SOON AS I WAS ON THE COI,^A WARD BOY~~S~~ CAME UP TO ME AND TOOK THE MEDICAL TAGS THAT WERE TIED ONTO ~~MY JACKET~~ MY JACKET. ANOTHER ONE CAME UP WITH A PAN OF HOT WATER AND A BAR OF SOAP AND TOWEL.

"WOULD YOU LIKE TO GET OUT OF THOSE CLOTHES AND WASH UP?" HE SAID TO ME KINDLY.

"YEA, THANKS A LOT. I GUESS I COULD USE IT." I ANSWERED ~~HIM~~

"TAKE ALL YOUR STUFF OUT OF YOUR POCKETS AND KEEP IT ON YOUR BED. JUST PUT YOUR DIRTY STUFF DOWN ON THE FLOOR AND THEY'LL GIVE YOU SOME CLEAN CLOTHES TO WEAR WHEN YOU LEAVE ~~OUT OF~~ HERE."

"LEAVE?" I ASKED. "WHEN? I JUST GOT HERE."

"I KNOW, BUT YOU'LL BE EVACUATED FROM HERE ^{in the morning} TO ANOTHER HOSPITAL FARTHER BACK IN THE REAR. THIS IS JUST A FIELD EVAC."

"OK BUDDY, THANKS."

I WAS SO TIRED AND SORE I COULD HARDLY TAKE MY OWN SHIRT OFF AND THE BIG BLONDE NURSE CAME OVER AND HELPED ME SQUIRM OUT OF X IT. I THANKED HER AND KINDA HESITATED ABOUT PULLING OFF MY PANTS I'VE ALWAYS BEEN SORT OF A MODEST GUY. BUT ~~XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ ~~XXXXX~~ ALL THE OTHER NEW PATIENTS WERE STRIPPING OFF THEIR PANTS AND SHIRTS SO I FIGURED, WHAT THE HELL. I PULLED MY TROUSERS GENTLY OFF OVER MY FEET AND JUST SAT THERE, RECOVERING FROM ALL THE EFFORT. I THINK GENERAL VON RUNDSTEDT HIMSELF COULD HAVE WALKED INTO THE TENT WITH A BUMP GUN IN HIS HAND AND I WOULD HAVE BEEN TOO TIRED TO MOVE A FINGER AGAINST HIM.

I BEGAN TO SOAK MY GRIMY HANDS IN THE WARM SOAPY WATER. MY HANDS ACHED PRETTY BADLY FROM THE COLD AND ALSO FROM THE DIRT AND MUD THAT COVERED THEM. THE DYE IN MY GLOVES HAD RUN FROM THE

WET SNOW AND HAD SOAKED INTO MY SKIN, GIVING MY HANDS A GREENISH BROWN COLOR. THEY LOOKED LIKE THE HANDS OF A CADAVER. I WORKED A FEW MINUTES WASHING ^{them} MY HANDS AND THEN WASHED MY ARMS AND FACE ~~AND~~ AND NECK. TRYING TO WASH ~~XXXXXX~~ AWAY ^{with} THE DIRT, THE MEMORY OF WHAT I HAD JUST COME FROM. BUT I COULDN'T STOP THINKING OF IT WE WERE STILL TOO MUCH A PART OF IT ALL. STILL TOO CLOSE TO THE SOUND OF THE ARTILLERY AND TANKS AND ^{THE} STACCATO BURSTS OF MACHINE GUN FIRE THAT COULD BE HEARD FAR OFF IN THE DISTANCE.

"WON'T GET MUCH SLEEP TONIGHT," I THOUGHT TO MYSELF. BUT I DIDN'T REALISE HOW TIRED AND UTTERLY EXHAUSTED I REALLY WAS. SOON AFTER I FINISHED WASHING I FELL BACK ONTO THE SCRATCHY WOOL ARMY BLANKETS, PULLED ONE OVER MYSELF AND SHUT MY EYES. SOME BODY CAME UP TO ME AND SAID.

" HERE SWALLOW THESE."

I PUT TWO LITTLE WHITE, OBLONG, GELATIN COVERED PILLS IN MY MOUTH, TOOK THE PAPER CUP OF WATER HE HANDED ME AND SWALLOWED OBEDIENTLY. I LAY BACK ON THE BED AND ONE OF THE NURSES WITH A NEEDLE APPROACHED MY COT. ^{SHE} LEANED OVER AND WIPED MY LEFT FORE ARM WITH SOMETHING COLD, ^{then} ~~AND~~ NEATLY PLUNGED THE NEEDLE IN ME (UP TO THE HILT, IT SEEMED.)

THAT WAS THE LAST THING I REMEMBERED.

I WAS AWAKENED IN THE MORNING EARLY, BY SOMEONE ASKING ME TO PLEASE PUT ON MY CLOTHES, I WAS GOING TO BE LEAVING IN A FEW MINUTES. I PUT ON THE ~~XXXXXX~~ WRINKLED, BUT CLEAN O D 'S THAT WERE LYING ACROSS THE FOOT OF MY COI. ALMOST AS SOON AS I HAD FINISHED DRESSING THE NURSE WHO HAD GIVEN ME THE SHOT THE NIGHT BEFORE CAME UP TO ME WITH THE TAGS AND A SLIP OF PAPER THAT LOOKED LIKE A RAILROAD TICKET. SHE HANDED THEM TO ME.

" HANG ON TO THESE, SOLDIER." SHE TOLD ME.

" YES MAM, DO YOU HAPPEN TO KNOW WHERE I'M GOING?" I ASKED.

" SURE, " SHE SMILED. " YOU'RE LEAVING FOR THE 16TH FIELD HOSPITAL IN LIEGE. "

" WHERE IS THAT? "

" OH, IT'S ABOUT THIRTY OR FORTY MILES FROM HERE. "

" IS THAT ALL? " I MUST HAVE SOUNDED PRETTY UNGRATEFUL FOR SHE ASKED.

" WHH, WHATS THE MATTER? "

" I JUST WANT TO GET AWAY FROM THE SOUND OF THOSE DAMNED GUNS. IT'S ABOUT TO DRIVE ME BATTY AND I'M GETTING NERVOUS AS A CAT. "XX

IT WAS LIKE GOING OUT OF THE FRYING PAN INTO THE FIRE. LIEGE WAS THE TOWN WHERE ABOUT HALF THE GERMAN BUZZ-BOMBS WERE LANDING

WE WERE DRIVEN BY AMBULANCE AGAIN ALONG THE HOUR OR SO DRIVE TO LIEGE. THE VEHICLES ROLLED OUT TO THE EDGE OF THE CITY AND WE DROVE IN THROUGH A BARBED WIRE GATE INTO A BIG FIELD. ALL OVER THE FIELD, LINED UP LIKE TROOPS AT INSPECTION WERE THE BIG TENTS THEIR LARGE WHITE CIRCLES WITH THE RED CROSSES SHINING TOWARD THE SKY.

ONIO A
AFTER BEING PUT IN ONE OF THE WARD TENIS AND ~~XXXXXX~~ BED,
I WAS GIVEN A PAIR OF PALE, BABY BLUE COLORED FLANNEL PAJAMAS.
A LITTLE SHORT NURSE CAME AROUND, LOOKED AT OUR TAGS AND EVAC.
SLIPS AND TOOK THEM UP, PUTTING THEM ON A BIG CLIP BOARD SHE
WAS CARRYING. IN CONTRAST TO THE NURSES AT THE OTHER HOSPITAL,
SHE WAS WEARING A UNIFORM OF SOME KIND OF ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ LIGHT
BROWN AND WHITE STRIPED MATERIAL OVER WHICH SHE WORE A LIGHT
TAN SWEATER. SHE HAD ON A CAP THE SAME COLOR AS HER UNIFORM.
ON THE ~~COLOR~~ ^{COLLAR} OF HER DRESS GLEAMED ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ THE SILVER BARS
OF A FIRST ~~XXX~~ LIEUTENANT.

I WAS AT THAT HOSPITAL ALL THAT DAY AND NIGHT. NOTHING UNUSU-
AL HAPPENED OUTSIDE OF THE FACT THAT EVERY FOUR HOURS, THE LITTLE
SHORT NURSE CAME AROUND AND SHOT ME IN THE LEFT ARM WITH PENICILLIN.
I FINALLY ASKED HER TO SHIFT TO THE OTHER ARM. THE LEFT ONE WAS
BEGINNING TO LOOK LIKE A PINGUISHION AFTER THE PINS ARE REMOVED.

THE NEXT MORNING ABOUT NINE O'CLOCK, "SHORTIE" (THAT WAS REALLY
WHAT THEY CALLED HER) CAME AROUND TO SEVERAL OF US IN THE WARD AND
TOLD US WE WERE BEING TAKEN TO PARIS ON A HOSPITAL TRAIN AND TO GET
OUR BELONGINGS TOGETHER. MY "BELONGINGS" AT THIS STAGE OF THE GAME
WERE MY BILLFOLD, A FOUNTAIN PEN GIVEN TO ME BY MY DAD BEFORE
COMING OVERSEAS, MY COMBAT INFANTRY BADGE, A WOOL KNIT CAP (VERY
DIRTY AND WELL WORN), A SMALL BIBLE WITH A METAL COVER AND ONE
RED CROSS DITTY BAG WHICH ON THE INSIDE HAD A LITTLE TAG READING

WESCHESTER COUNTY RED CROSS
CHAPTER.

~~MY SINCERE THANKS TO THE WOMEN OF THAT RED CROSS CHAPTER.~~
THANK YOU, LADIES.

~~XXXXX~~ JUST BEFORE ~~XXXXX~~ NOON, WE WERE TAKEN ~~DOWN~~ BACK INTO THE CITY AND DOWN TO THE RAILROAD STATION. THERE WERE BELGIAN CIVILIAN MEN UNLOADING THE MANY AMBULANCES AND LOADING THE LITTERS ONTO THE TRAIN. ~~THEY WERE VERY KIND TO US AND WE GAVE THEM SOME OF THE CIGARETTES FROM THE ONE PACK WHICH WE HAD RECEIVED IN THE LITTLE RED CROSS DITTY BAGS.~~

THE CARS OF THE TRAIN WERE LONG COACHES WITH LARGE WINDOWS. PROMINENTLY DISPLAYED ON THE SIDES AND TOP OF EACH COACH WERE ~~THE~~ ^{LARGE} ~~LARGE~~ RED CROSSES ON A WHITE BACKGROUND. ~~ON~~ THE INTERIOR WAS PAINTED A CREAM ^{white that made the car} COLOR ~~AND SEEMED VERY BRIGHT AND CHEERFUL.~~ THE LITTERS WERE PLACED IN RACKS ALONG ^{EACH} ~~THE~~ SIDE OF THE COACH AND WERE STACKED THREE HIGH. THE ONE ON THE BOTTOM WAS RIGHT ON THE FLOOR OF THE COACH AND IT WAS THERE MY LITTER WAS PLACED.

WE ALL WERE PRETTY EXCITED ABOUT THE TRIP. THE CHANCE OF GETTING REALLY AWAY FROM THE COMBAT ZONE WAS TOO GOOD TO BELIEVE. AND PARIS WAS EVEN MORE UNBELIEVABLE. AS EACH NEW BUNCH OF ARRIVALS ~~WERE~~ ^{was} LOADED INTO OUR CAR, THERE WAS AN EXCHANGE OF WISE CRACKS AND GREETINGS BETWEEN THE MEN AND ^{THE} ~~THE~~ NURSE AND WARD BOY WHO WERE IN CHARGE ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~.

SANDWICHES ~~XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ WITH HOT CHOCOLATE WERE SERVED TO US FOR LUNCH. EVERYBODY HOLLERED FOR SECONDS AND WE GOT 'EM. AROUND TWO OR THREE THAT AFTERNOON THE TRAIN HAD FINISHED LOADING AND WE BEGAN TO MOVE SLOWLY OUT OF LIEGE

THE TRIP ~~XXXXX~~ TO PARIS WAS LONG AND TIRESOME. THE TRAIN MOVED SLOWLY AND MANY TIMES WAS STOPPED FOR SEVERAL HOURS ~~XXXXXXXXXX~~ ^A THE FELLAS IN THE CAR WERE ^A PRETTY JOLLY BUNCH. WE SANG SONGS. SOME OF THE MEN MANAGED TO GET THEMSELVES INTO POSITION TO PLAY

SOME TWO-MAN CASINO. OTHERS SLEPT NEARLY ALL THE WAY, MYSELF |
BEING ONE OF ~~those~~ ^{quite} ~~them~~. I WAS STILL ~~plenty~~ TIRED AND I FELT LIKE I
~~XXXXX~~ COULD STAY IN A BED THE REST OF MY LIFE. I WAS A LITTLE
UNSURE OF MY POSITION HOWEVER. THE MAN IN THE BUTTER ABOVE ME
~~WASXSMKXXXXXX~~ BESIDES HAVING SEVERAL PIECES OF SH RAPNEL IN
HIS LEG, ALSO HAD A BAD CASE OF DIARRHEA.

THE GARE DU NORD OF PARIS WAS ~~■~~ HUSHED AND SOMBER AT ⁶ ~~6~~ A M
WHEN WE WERE TAKEN FROM THE TRAIN, LOADED ONCE MORE INTO WAITING
AMBULANCES AND RUSHED AWAY ~~XXXXX~~ ^{though} THE SILENT STREETS. WE WERE STOPPED
AT ONE POINT BY TWO SUB MACHINE GUN-CARRYING MILITARY POLICEMEN.
THEY FLASHED A LIGHT THROUGH THE WINDOW BY THE DRIVER, BACK INTO
THE REAR, ON US, AND THEN ALLOWED US TO GO ON. THE DRIVER EXPLAINED
TO US THAT THEY WERE TRYING TO FIND SOME REPORTED GERMAN SPIES
WHO WERE IN PARIS ON A MISSION TO KILL SOME OF THE TOP U S ARMY
COMMANDERS. IT LOOKED ^{as though} ~~like~~ THE COM ZONE WAS ALSO HAVING A LITTLE
EXCITEMENT THIS TIME.

I WAS SO SLEEPY I DIDN'T SEE WHERE WE WERE GOING OR WHERE WE
WERE WHEN WE ARRIVED. THE HOSPITAL WAS AN ~~ANN~~ IMMENSE BUILDING IN
THE DOWNTOWN SECTION OF PARIS. THE AMBULANCE SWUNG THROUGH THE
GATES PAST A GUARD, AROUND A BIG GRASS COVERED COURTYARD AND CAME
TO A STOP IN FRONT OF ONE OF THE ~~XXXXXXXXX~~ ^{SURROUNDING} ~~XXXXX~~ WINGS. I ~~DIDN'T~~
HARDLY WAKEN ^{AS} I WAS CARRIED ~~XXXXX~~ INSIDE AND PUT IN A WARD ON THE
FIRST FLOOR.

THAT MORNING A ~~DOCTOR~~ MEDICAL OFFICER CAME BY MY BED AND STOPPED TO TALK TO ME.

"HOW DO YOU FEEL?"

"PRETTY GOOD SIR!...STILL A LITTLE TIRED."

HE WAS A CAPTAIN, GREY HAired, AND WITH THE FACE OF A SCHOOL TEACHER OR PROFESSOR. HE DIDN'T LOOK LIKE A DOCTOR, THO I'M SURE HE WAS A GOOD ONE. HE TALKED WITH ME ABOUT TEN MINUTES, LOOKING AT MY FEET AND THE FINGERS WHICH WERE FROSTBITTEN. HE WROTE SOMETHING ON ~~THE~~ ONE OF THE MANY LITTLE TICKETS WHICH I HAD BY NOW AND PUT THEM IN AN ENVELOPE AND HUNG IT ON THE HEAD OF MY BED.

"GOOD LUCK." HE SAID AND WENT TO THE NEXT MAN.

I WASHED AND SHAVED THEN STARTED TO READ ONE OF THE MAGAZINES WHICH WERE LYING ON THE ~~LITTLE~~ ^{small} TABLE AT THE HEAD OF MY BED. DIFFERENT NURSES CAME BY AND LOOKED AT MY RECORDS IN THE ~~LITTLE~~ ENVELOPE ONCE OR TWICE. THE KID IN THE BED NEXT TO ME NUDGED ME.

"HEY JOE, WHAT DOES U K MEAN?"

"SEARCH ME," I SAID "WHY?"

"THAT DOC JUST WROTE IT ON MY CARD. HE PUT IT ON YOURS TOO. I WAS WATCHIN' 'IM."

I ~~XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX~~ TWISTED THE ENVELOPE AROUND ON ITS STRING AND AT THE BOTTOM WERE WRITTEN TWO LETTERS. U K .

"LETS ASK THE NURSE" I SAID.

"HEY, LIEUTENANT."

"YES?"

"WHAT DOES U K MEAN?"

"THATS WHERE YOU'RE GOING." SHE TOLD US,

" WHAT?" I CRIED, " YOU MEAN I'M GONNA BE MOVED AGAIN? I CAN'T STOP IN ONE PLACE LONG ENOUGH TO GO TO THE LATRINE."

" WELL, WHERE IS U K ? " THE KID ASKED HER.

" ENGLAND. YOU'LL BE FLOWN TO ENGLAND IN A DAY OR TWO. YOU'RE LEAVING HERE THIS AFTERNOON FOR ANOTHER HOSPITAL! "

WE SPENT FOUR DAYS AT THE 8TH AIR EVAC HOSPITAL ON THE OUTSKIRTS OF PARIS, WAITING FOR THE WEATHER TO BREAK. THE DAYS WOULD BE CLEAR AND PERFECT AS FAR AS WE WERE CONCERNED BUT THEN THEY WOULD TELL US THE WEATHER WAS NO GOOD OVER THE CHANNEL AND IN ENGLAND.

FINALLY, ON THE FIFTH DAY, THEY CAME FOR US AND WE ALL CHEERED WHEN THE LITTERS APPEARED IN THE DOOR AND A G I GRINNED.

" WHO'S GONNA BE FIRST?"

WE WERE TAKEN TO LE BOURGET FIELD, LOADED INTO C 47 HOSPITAL PLANES AND THAT EVENING AT DUSK WERE SETTLING DOWN FOR OUR LANDING AT A FIELD SOUTH OF ~~KONKONK~~ OXFORD. WE SPENT THE NIGHT AT A HOSPITAL NEAR THE FIELD. AS SOON AS WE WERE TAKEN INTO THE WARD AND THE NURSE WALKED IN WE ALL GROANED IN CHORUS,

" WE KNOW..... TOMORROW WE'LL BE SENT TO ANOTHER HOSPITAL! "